

פרשת בראשית. Everybody's favorite פרשה. We love בראשית. I had the זכות to hear the following vort from Zeidy Weiss, ע"ה, who was such a מענטש. He said this so sweetly that it was unforgettable, as many of the things that he did, and it's good to pass it along to you. He heard it in the name of R' Rosenzweig, the מרא דאתרא of the עדת ישורון, and he heard it from R' Yoshe Ber Soloveitchik - that's a pretty impressive line of דאמרינ'.

The pasuk says (1:16) וַיַּעַשׂ אֱלֹהִים אֶת שְׁנֵי הַמָּאֲרוֹת הַגְּדֹלִים אֶת הַמָּאֹר הַגָּדֹל לְמַשְׁלֵת הַיּוֹם וְאֶת הַמָּאֹר הַקָּטָן לְמַשְׁלֵת הַלַּיְלָה וְאֵת הַכּוֹכָבִים. R' Soloveitchik asked the following question on this pasuk: At a bris we say זֶה הַקָּטָן יִהְיֶה גָּדוֹל יְהִיָּה. It's a famous ברכה, that we want this little one to become big. So the obvious קשיא is what kind of ברכה is that? It is the nature of things - he's a little kid, he's going to grow up. That's a ברכה? What is the intention of this ברכה? We should say he should become a צדיק, he should be a חכם. תלמיד חכם. What is the פשט - פשט יְהִיָּה - זֶה הַקָּטָן גָּדוֹל יְהִיָּה?

So the Rav refers to this pasuk, the two מָאֲרוֹת הַגְּדֹלִים, the מָאֹר הַגָּדֹל, which is the sun, and the מָאֹר הַקָּטָן, which is the moon. We know that the sun illuminates on its own power. We know that the moon is simply a reflection of the light of the sun. So too each and every one of us. When we're young and learning and our parents are raising us and our רביים, our teachers are teaching us, we are all receiving instruction, receiving חכמה, receiving תורה, receiving all the things we need to grow up properly and to stand on our own. As children, when we have light, it's a reflection of that which was instilled within us, the light reflecting off of the sun. That's a מָאֹר הַקָּטָן. In that ברכה, we daven that בעזרת השם we should get to a point in our lives when we're big enough that we will be able to illuminate on our own, a מָאֹר הַגָּדֹל, that we will take what we've gotten from our previous teachers and דורות and use that to start our own light, to instill within ourselves the ability to fire up our own light and to illuminate those around us and those who come after us. So it's a beautiful take on these words זֶה הַקָּטָן גָּדוֹל יְהִיָּה.

השם, בעזרת השם, we should all have the זכות to illuminate all those around us.

